



Solutions Architect Take-Home Assessment

We are pleased to share with you the next step in our Solutions Architect interview process: a technical skills assessment that includes building a project and presenting it. This assessment will give you the opportunity to demonstrate your technical prowess, understanding of business value, the Vercel platform and your presentation skills.

Prompt: Build something small on Vercel that solves a real problem, then present it like you would to a customer.

1. Pick a problem you can explain clearly
2. Build a small solution
3. Submit and present your deployed project

No slides or formal presentation necessary, you'll present your project itself and discuss the code, architecture and your technical decisions

Overview

Time to Submit

1 Week

Build Time

4–6 Hours

Presentation

45 Minutes

Choose Your Track

Track A

Frontend Cloud

Build a web app that shows thoughtful rendering and performance choices.

Examples

- A dashboard with filtering and fast perceived load
- A content-heavy site where SEO and caching actually matter
- A multi-locale experience using edge routing

Note: We want to see dynamic, personalized, or real-time elements. Not a purely static site.

We'll discuss

- Rendering strategy trade-offs (SSR, SSG, partial prerendering, streaming)
- Caching and revalidation
- How your choices connect to Core Web Vitals (LCP, CLS), SEO, and cost

or

Track B

AI Cloud

Build a small AI-powered product or agent.

Examples

- A RAG-based support assistant
- A PR review helper
- An agentic workflow with tool use and fallback handling

Required: Include at least one lightweight evaluation approach (a test set, rubric, or hallucination regression check). Use the AI SDK (Vercel Gateway is optional).

We'll discuss

- Prompting, context selection, and fallback behavior
- Model choice, cost/latency trade-offs, and safety
- How you'd pitch and implement this with an enterprise customer

Notes on Building

AI Tools	Totally fine. Just make sure you understand what you built and can explain the decisions.
Scope	Small and deep beats large and murky every time. Pick something you can defend well.
Framework	Your call. Next.js, Nuxt, SvelteKit, whatever. Next.js fluency is useful in the role, but it's not what we're grading.

How We Evaluate

Problem Framing

Clear "why," defined audience, and picture of success

Production Thinking

Security, reliability, failure modes, and observability

Communication

Clear, confident presentation as if to a customer

Architectural Judgment

Sensible boundaries with explicit, defensible trade-offs

Business Value

Connect technical choices to outcomes for different audiences

Platform Understanding

Know when to use a feature—and when not to

During the Interview

0–5 min

Introductions

15–20 min

Live demo-style presentation

- Present as if you're a Solutions Architect speaking to a customer
- Focus on business benefits and technical implementation (not just a feature showcase)
- Explain *how* you built it, not just *what* you built
- Demonstrate understanding of Next.js/AI SDK business value

Remaining time

Open discussion

- Digging in on technical decisions, architecture and/or code
- Open Q&A

What to Submit & How

1 Deployed Project

2 Repo Link

Public URL (or reviewer credentials if auth is required)

Readable code with comments where you made deliberate decisions

Send your repo and deployed URL to your recruiting contacts and hiring manager **at least 24 hours before** your scheduled interview.

Include in your email:

- Cassidy Nguyen (cassidy.nguyen@vercel.com)
- Your recruiter
- Your hiring manager

If you need clarification on who to contact, please ask Cassidy or your recruiter.

All the Best,
Vercel TA Team